DAILY MEDIA ENERGY MONITOR

09 Jun - 11 June 2026

Business Recorder	The Express Tribune	Dawn	The Guardian	The News International
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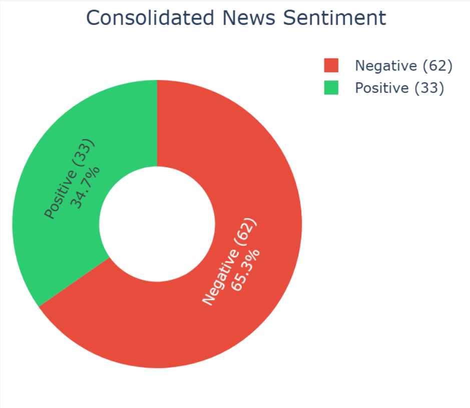

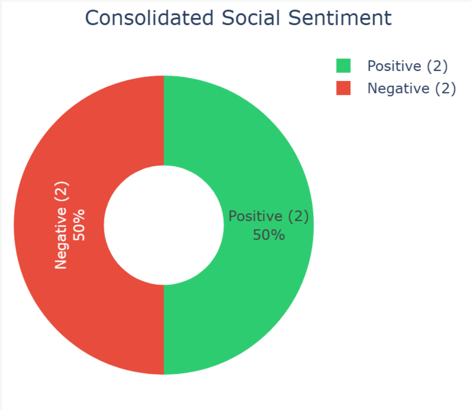

Executive Summaries

11 June 2026:

Pakistan's economy, buoyed by 3.7% GDP growth in FY2025–26, faces entrenched challenges: inflation, energy volatility, and weak private investment. Key initiatives like the USD4.5B Hub refinery and CPEC-2.0 aim to boost energy security, jobs, and exports, yet are hampered by policy inconsistency, regulatory delays, and provincial resistance. Despite remittances and forex reserves, informal channels and lobbying persist. Global oil shocks, including the Hormuz blockade and U.S.-Iran tensions, amplify inflation and investment risks. To unlock sustainable growth, the government must prioritize tax reform, debt reduction, energy affordability, and aligned fiscal-monetary policy—avoiding inflationary missteps while accelerating renewables, EV standards, and export incentives to drive resilient, export-led recovery.

10 June 2026:

Pakistan’s energy and fiscal system is besieged by chronic inefficiency, corruption, and policy inertia, despite green ambitions and CPEC-driven growth. Rising debt, delayed budgets, and provincial fiscal tensions threaten stability, while renewables remain sidelined. Privatization of DISCOs and AI-driven innovation offer potential, yet public pressure mounts over load-shedding, inflation, and institutional stagnation. Judicial restraint and IMF conditions constrain reform, while political deadlock and constitutional strain risk collapse. Climate crises and SME underdevelopment intensify urgency for integrated, non-austerity reforms—centered on renewables, fiscal consolidation, and public-private tech partnerships—to restore resilience and public trust.

09 June 2026:

Pakistan’s FY2026–27 budget faces escalating energy inflation, subsidy cuts, and grid integration hurdles, risking economic strain and energy poverty. While austerity yields savings, urgent reforms—renewables, grid modernization, and strategic reserves—are vital to restore competitiveness and energy security. Stalled federal negotiations and provincial resistance delay progress, amid business calls for tax reforms and export diversification. Global energy volatility, including Red Sea disruptions, adds pressure. Domestic savings have plummeted, prompting financial inclusion and fiscal restraint measures. The EV policy and digital infrastructure gaps highlight emerging challenges, while U.S.-led diplomacy offers temporary relief amid persistent geopolitical risks. Coordinated, transparent governance is critical to navigate global volatility and domestic reform.

Key Energy Topics

Net Metering

Trade deficit surge

Pakistan's FY26 trade deficit widened amid energy reliance on imports, threatening economic stability. Renewables investment is urged as a long-term solution to reduce foreign exchange dependence, alongside diversifying exports beyond textiles and boosting high-value sectors. Energy security and import substitution are critical for fiscal resilience....

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Is debt servicing manageable? - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces escalating debt servicing costs (up to 10% interest rate), rising public debt, and fiscal stagnation, undermining public spending on health, education, and infrastructure. Despite constitutional provisions, provincial budgets are squeezed by inflation and fixed costs. The IMF and UNCTAD warn of deepening debt distress, with no clear policy fix—highlighting systemic structural challenges over short-term tweaks....

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More than half of clean energy schemes needed for Labour's 2030 target offered grid connection

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Solarization

Spinwam gas bidding violates rules

Pakistan's petroleum ministry faces scrutiny over a gas field sale tender violating OGRA licensing rules, contradicting CCI-approved frameworks. Concerns over unfair advantage for unlicensed bidders risk legal challenges. Authorities are urged to withdraw and reissue the tender to ensure regulatory compliance and fair competition....

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EV makers using substandard batteries

Pakistan's EV boom faces quality risks as regulators push for battery testing standards amid rising oil prices. OMCs violate fuel regulations, prompting regulatory reforms. SNGPL to manage CNG supply amid energy security concerns. Renewables and clean mobility ambitions remain central to national energy strategy....

Read More → | Tribune | Negative

Budget: tax on hybrid cars may stay unchanged; up to 25pc sales tax on import of EVs likely - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government plans to impose 25% sales tax on imported EVs post-June 30, 2026, while extending customs duty exemptions for EV parts and locally assembled vehicles. The AIDEP 2021-26 policy supports green manufacturing, aligning with broader renewables and electric mobility goals....

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Privatisation

PM directs to accelerate privatisation process of power DISCOs

PM Shehbaz Sharif prioritizes privatisation of three loss-making DISCOs (IESCO, GEPCO, FESCO) in Phase 1, urging transparency, investor roadshows (incl. Saudi, Türkiye, China), and robust regulation. Cabinet approves transaction structures; process to be expedited with international engagement....

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PM Shehbaz orders swift Discos privatisation

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif prioritizes privatisation of three loss-making DISCOs, launching investor roadshows with global participation. He also reaffirmed commitments to global health partnerships, including the Global Fund, to eradicate TB, HIV, and malaria through joint working groups....

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Big Discos: PM directs authorities to fast-track sell-off process - Business Recorder

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif accelerates privatisation of key power distribution firms (IESCO, GEPCO, FESCO), aiming to reduce fiscal pressure, boost efficiency, and attract global investors via roadshows in Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and China, under a transparent regulatory framework to safeguard consumers....

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Indus Treaty suspension raises global concerns

Pakistan's climate minister warns of rising unilateralism, citing the suspended Indus Waters Treaty, amid focus on climate resilience, energy security, and renewable adoption. Bilateral talks with Spain highlight cooperation in green energy, climate education, and sustainable development initiatives....

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Govt urged to incorporate proposals of business community in budget - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistani business leaders urge government to prioritize sustainable growth in Federal Budget 2026-27, advocating tax reform, reduced business costs, affordable energy, and expanded formal economy. Emphasis on export competitiveness, sectoral incentives, and customs duty review to boost industrial and export activity....

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PJBF urges govt to safeguard industrial investment, local manufacturing - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's auto sector faces risk from potential duty cuts on imported CBU vehicles and parts, threatening local manufacturing, jobs, and foreign exchange. The Pakistan-Japan Business Forum urges policy stability, stakeholder consultation, and protection of long-term investments to sustain industrialization and localization....

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Public procurement of electricity could save GB households £200 a year, says thinktank

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Remittance rush: Don't miss the fine print! - BR Research - Business Recorder

Pakistan's remittances hit a $4.25B May record, driven by UAE surges and Eid timing, but analysts warn this is a temporary windfall. UAE outflows reflect repatriated savings, not sustained growth. With labor outflows slowing and regional uncertainty, policymakers must avoid inflationary missteps and treat this as a short-term boost, not a structural shift....

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Tariff Hikes

Fuel Price Adjustment

Load Shedding

FCC entertains POL levy, tariff pleas

Pakistan's Federal Constitutional Court has accepted petitions challenging the petroleum levy and price hikes, urging an independent review. The government imposed the levy under IMF commitments, with rates at Rs117.41/litre for petrol and Rs42.60/litre for HSD. Legal scrutiny highlights fiscal and constitutional concerns amid ongoing energy policy debates....

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Fiscal consolidation may raise energy prices

Pakistan's FY2027 budget risks exacerbating energy inflation and economic strain via regressive taxes and subsidy cuts, while renewables face grid integration hurdles. Experts urge efficiency-driven reforms, grid modernisation, and market-based pricing to restore competitiveness and affordability, warning of rising energy poverty and industrial disruption....

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NEPRA slashes power tariff by Rs1.98

Nepra reduced electricity tariffs by Rs1.9857/unit for June–August 2026, saving Rs67B, including K-Electric consumers. Public hearing addressed FCA concerns, with officials noting net consumer benefit. Natural gas plant efficiency urged to continue, aiding future cost relief....

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PM says all decisions taken in national interest in NEC meeting, praises CMs' cooperation in budget-making

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif highlights macroeconomic stability, urging accelerated growth via provincial-federal coordination. Key budgetary moves include a Rs1T PSDP, deferred NEC meeting, and provincial resource reallocation. IMF engagement continues, while defense and water projects gain priority amid rising oil prices and regional tensions. Renewables not mentioned....

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Budget delayed, budget denied? - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal government seeks to retain 1.2 trillion rupees from provincial NFC shares for "strategic spending," sparking constitutional controversy. IMF concerns loom over fiscal credibility. Budget delays risk political instability and economic strain, amid rising inflation and policy rate expectations. Renewables and water conservation are urged over infrastructure overemphasis....

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Is stability enough? - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's economy has stabilized through monetary easing and reserve buildup, but private investment remains weak. While SBP's OMOs and FX purchases support financial order, they risk diverting capital from productivity. True recovery requires export-driven growth, private investment, and fiscal sustainability—not just stability....

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Pakistan rushes to spot market for LNG supplies

Pakistan seeks spot LNG cargoes for June 2026 amid halted Qatari supplies due to Strait of Hormuz closure. Government reversed earlier rejection, aiming to avoid load-shedding. Rising costs and declining local gas production heighten reliance on imports, with renewables playing minimal role in current strategy....

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Ahsan-led team, KP CM take up NEC meeting, other major issues - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa protests federal energy cuts, gas shortages, and delayed hydropower projects. Provincial leaders demand constitutional rights, fiscal equity, and faster approvals for infrastructure. Federal minister pledges to expedite Peshawar Bus Terminal clearance and present grievances to top forums. Renewables and energy sector grievances remain central to intergovernmental tensions....

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Pakistan's IT sector: a billion dollars, and still off the map - Perspectives - Business Recorder

Pakistan's freelance IT exports surged to $3.39B, with freelancers earning $959M—celebrating global labor success. Yet, innovation lags: falling in Global Innovation Index, with weak R&D and co-invention. Key opportunity: deepen China-Pakistan Economic Corridor's focus on joint R&D, patents, and knowledge transfer to build lasting innovation capacity, not just exports....

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BMG urges govt to avoid repeating past policy mistakes - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

KCCI & BMG urge federal government to reverse failed policies: restore Final Tax Regime, revive RCET, scrap Super Tax, and fix energy inefficiencies. They highlight export losses, high industrial costs, and digital system flaws, while welcoming PM Shehbaz's engagement and commitments to improve business environment. Renewables & industrial competitiveness remain key priorities....

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Lasbela Chamber urges govt to introduce comprehensive reforms - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Lasbela Chamber urges federal reforms to boost industrial growth, including tax simplification, renewable energy adoption, FDI incentives, and SME support. Emphasis on predictable policies, digital infrastructure, and export facilitation aims to attract investment and stabilize the economy amid high energy costs and inflation concerns....

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Why the Houthis are threatening Red Sea shipping and what it means for oil markets

Houthis, backed by Iran, have banned Israeli-linked vessels from the Red Sea, risking global oil flows amid regional tensions. Saudi Arabia rerouted 70% of its exports via Yanbu. While Houthi actions remain limited, their threat of escalation could disrupt energy markets, with past attacks forcing costly reroutes and raising fears of renewed instability....

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World's largest banks pledged $906bn to fossil fuel companies in 'unfathomable' increase in 2025, report finds

Global banks increased fossil fuel lending to $906bn, undermining climate goals. Major institutions like JPMorgan and Bank of America led the charge, despite political shifts and declining commitments. Renewables lagged, while oil/gas firms profited amid rising energy costs. Regulatory pressure is now urged to replace voluntary pledges....

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MQM-P moves resolution in Sindh Assembly against KE over power outages

Karachi residents face severe load-shedding during heatwaves, prompting MQM-P to demand immediate cessation and legal action. K-Electric's non-compliance with assembly directives is criticized, with demands for transparency and accountability amid ongoing power shortages and health risks....

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Who will do it? - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy sector faces chronic inefficiencies, corruption, and policy inertia. Despite widespread awareness of issues like power shortages, tax evasion, and school dropouts, systemic inaction and bureaucratic red tape hinder progress. Renewables and reforms are underutilized; public pressure demands urgent, collective action to restore trust and drive sustainable development....

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Power regulator drops show-cause notice against LPCL - Markets - Business Recorder

NEPRA is pursuing penalties against LPCL for delayed synchronization post-January 2023 blackout, citing regulatory violations. LPCL argues jurisdiction lies with PPAs and claims double punishment. The incident highlights grid resilience challenges and regulatory tensions over contractual vs. statutory enforcement in Pakistan's energy sector....

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DISCOs & KE: Consumers to get Rs1.9857 relief in June, July & August bills: Nepra - Business Recorder

NEPRA approved a Rs 1.9857/kWh tariff relief for DISCOs and K-Electric (June–Aug 2026), reducing consumer bills amid PPP and T&D loss adjustments. Public hearing ensured transparency; CPPA-G directed to provide plant-wise data. Relief excludes lifeline, prepaid, and incremental consumers....

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Budget for the people - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's FY2026-27 budget faces intense public scrutiny amid chronic inflation, poverty, and energy crises. Critics demand austerity, reduced elite privileges, and greater domestic resource mobilization. Renewables and energy reforms are underemphasized, while debt servicing and corruption undermine public welfare. The budget's success hinges on prioritizing human dignity over fiscal optics....

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MYT determination: Nepra rejects MEPCO's review motion - Business Recorder

NEPRA rejected MEPCO's review motion on its MYT, citing insufficient investment allowances and operational concerns. MEPCO highlighted efficiency gains and requested higher funding for tech upgrades, citing disparities with other DISCOs and donor constraints. NEPRA upheld its 2026-29 tariffs, with final approval pending federal notification....

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Here are 10 ways a 'super' El Niño could impact the planet | Benjamin Selwyn

A super El Niño is intensifying global food insecurity, disrupting supply chains, and increasing coal use and wildfire risks. It threatens fisheries, hydropower, and agriculture, exacerbating geopolitical tensions and health crises. Renewables offer a path forward, but systemic change is needed to mitigate disproportionate global impacts....

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Budget proposals: PBF asks KP govt to focus on industrialisation - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

KP's industrial potential is underutilized despite rich resources and hydropower. Business leaders urge the provincial government to prioritize industrial development in the 2026-27 budget, calling for infrastructure, energy subsidies, SME incentives, and value-addition facilities to boost exports, employment, and economic resilience....

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Pakistan's refineries: between revenue needs and energy security - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's refining sector faces policy uncertainty amid fiscal shifts, including tax exemptions and furnace oil levies, undermining brownfield upgrades. Despite government incentives, erratic tax treatment and declining furnace oil demand constrain investment. The sector's underutilisation threatens energy security, foreign exchange, and industrial competitiveness—highlighting the need for stable, predictable policy to align fiscal goals with lo...

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Broaden tax net, cut tariff distortions: Sustainable Development Policy Institute - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's energy & fiscal experts urge budget reforms prioritizing climate resilience, job creation, and renewables over short-term revenue. They call for tax base expansion, social spending as productivity investment, and integrated climate planning—rejecting tax burdens on salaried classes and tariff distortions. Renewables must be incentivized, with budgets serving development strategy, not fiscal balancing....

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Australia news live: ASX slumps amid tech selloff; Australians unhappier now than during the pandemic

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The petroleum question: putting the levy story in context - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget maintains low petroleum levies post-crisis, avoiding price spikes amid global oil volatility. Institutional reforms, strategic reserves, and fiscal restraint preserved consumer relief. Electricity tariffs remain stable, with targeted subsidies. The government prioritizes predictability over adjustment, leveraging macro-stability and diplomatic success to sustain energy affordability....

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Traders seek business-friendly measures in budget - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's industrialists and traders urge government policy reforms and immediate economic relief, citing high energy costs and interest rates as growth barriers. Emphasis is on manufacturing, agriculture, youth employment, and renewables to unlock economic potential, with calls for agricultural emergency programs and industrial zones....

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Leghari reviews progress on power project for Gwadar - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government is advancing a 40 MW Gwadar power project under CPEC, open to competitive bidding with flexible tech options including renewables. The project aims to meet rising demand in the strategic port city, reducing reliance on imported electricity from Iran. Financing, operation, and maintenance will be handled by the winning bidder under a PPA....

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The missing budget debate: Pakistan's savings collapse - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's domestic savings have plummeted from 17.4% to 6.4% of GDP, hampering sustainable growth. The Finance Bill FY2026-27 must incentivize formal savings, reduce public dissaving, and improve financial access—especially for women and rural populations—to rebuild a resilient savings base and reduce reliance on foreign capital....

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Energy dept, its allied departments: PAC reviews audit paras, orders recovery of dues - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Punjab's Public Accounts Committee flagged major financial losses and irregularities in energy & allied departments, including gas turbine fire, forex arbitration costs, and non-compliant procurements. It directed urgent recovery of outstanding amounts and strict compliance with regulations, highlighting governance and fiscal control concerns....

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WB trims $400m program rating

Pakistan's tax reform program, funded by the World Bank, has been downgraded due to slow progress, weak compliance, and systemic hurdles like withholding tax burdens and lack of digital infrastructure. Despite some digital advances, core objectives—like tax compliance and e-services—remain unmet, highlighting governance and political will as critical, not financial, drivers for success....

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President, PM ease budget rift as K-P flags share cap

Pakistan's federal government seeks to retain Rs1.2 trillion from provincial NFC shares for strategic spending, sparking political and fiscal uncertainty. Provinces resist, citing legal and procedural hurdles, while the IMF opposes using NEC to deduct funds. Budget delays loom, with fiscal instability and weak FBR performance exacerbating tensions....

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Government debt climbs to Rs58tr

Pakistan's government debt rose in April 2026 amid rising domestic borrowing, driven by short-term MTBs and persistent fiscal deficits. External debt also increased, aiding forex reserves. Analysts note investor shift to short-term instruments due to rate uncertainty. Despite rising debt, fiscal consolidation and revenue growth suggest cautious management. Renewables not mentioned....

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NEC meets as provinces step in to fund Centre

Pakistan's NEC approved a Rs3.2T development budget, 25% below original proposals, after provinces granted Rs920B in grants. Fiscal consolidation, defense priorities, and IMF coordination are key. Growth targets (4%) and export focus are set, with renewables and productivity reforms urged to drive economic recovery....

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Budget must prioritise strategic petroleum reserves - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026–27 budget faces critical opportunity to establish strategic petroleum reserves amid chronic oil dependency and fiscal vulnerability. A dedicated, ring-fenced fund from petroleum levies, phased implementation, and strong governance are essential to enhance energy security and reduce external shock exposure—moving beyond policy talk to actionable strategy....

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No consensus yet on provinces' shares under NFC Award - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal budget process is stalled due to provincial resistance to surrendering NFC shares for strategic spending, pending IMF negotiations, and revised fiscal projections. KP faces reduced federal allocations, while GDP growth targets were lowered and job creation goals questioned. Legal and technical concerns surround fiscal transfers, delaying budget presentation....

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Tariff Policy Board approves second-year tariff rationalisation plan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Tariff Policy Board approved Year-II NTP 2025–30 adjustments, reducing Regulatory Duties and ACDs, with exemptions for local/export goods. NTC proposed removing 2% ACD on edible oils (Rs. 26B loss) and rationalizing RDs, while Commerce supports phased reductions. Implementation starts July 1, 2026, under PM approval....

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Tariff rationalisation: TPB approves second-year plan under NTP - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Tariff Policy Board approved Year-II NTP 2025–30 adjustments, reducing Regulatory Duties and ACDs, with exemptions for local/export goods. NTC proposed removing 2% ACD on edible oils (Rs. 26B loss) and rationalizing RDs, while Commerce supports phased reductions. Implementation begins July 1, 2026, under PM approval....

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IMF programmes’ progress report: some reflections—III - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s energy & fiscal policy faces criticism for inadequate IMF support, weak climate action, and reliance on fossil fuels. Non-austerity, non-neoliberal policies are urged to stabilize currency, reduce inflation, and boost renewables. Critics highlight insufficient financing, poor subsidy targeting, and lack of climate-focused reforms amid rising oil prices and climate catastrophes....

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Budget FY27: choosing growth over stability - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s economy faces a stability-vs.-growth dilemma, with fiscal constraints, high debt servicing, and regressive taxation stifling growth. Renewables and export sectors are underutilized; energy costs remain high, and circular debt persists. The government must prioritize debt reduction, tax reform, and energy affordability to unlock sustainable development....

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The high cost of easy revenues - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's fiscal and monetary policies are misaligned, driving inflation and stifling investment. High petroleum levies, coupled with tight monetary policy, have pushed inflation into double digits, prompting a 100 bps rate hike. The government's reliance on indirect taxes and lack of coordination risk deepening economic stagnation, with GDP growth below 4% and FDI low. A revised budget is urgently needed to break this cycle....

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Budget: getting close to plugging the gap - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal-provincial fiscal pact freezes 2026-27 divisible pool releases, easing revenue pressure. Provinces aim to boost own revenues via GST, AIT reforms, and IMF-backed enforcement. Despite fiscal tightening, global economic headwinds and enforcement delays threaten progress. Federal government seeks strategic funding via reduced spending....

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A backdoor NFC revision? - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Fiscal tensions escalate as the federal government pressures provinces to freeze NFC shares, risking budget deficits. Critics blame low tax collection and debt, not the 7th NFC Award. Experts warn of constitutional erosion and IMF-driven budget constraints, with proposals for radical fiscal reforms or full provincial tax control. Political deadlock and IMF pressure loom over Pakistan’s energy and fiscal future....

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BUDGET 2026-27: Centre, Punjab & Sindh agree on spending cuts - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan’s 2026–27 budget is imminent, with federal-provincial coordination to cover a Rs800bn shortfall and allocate Rs1.3–1.7tr for strategic needs. Sindh & Punjab cut ADPs; KP & Balochistan not yet involved. Customs duty exclusion mooted. Renewables & infrastructure projects like M6 scaled up, amid fiscal austerity and delayed provincial participation....

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Centre vs provinces - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan’s federal-provincial fiscal tensions escalate amid IMF conditions, with Islamabad demanding provinces freeze divisible pool shares and return surplus receipts — sparking constitutional risks. Revenue shortfalls stem from under-taxation and structural gaps, not provincial transfers. The standoff threatens federal autonomy and long-term economic stability....

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The Cost of Delay: Pakistan's environment at a tipping point - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces escalating climate and environmental crises—floods, pollution, water scarcity—impacting economy and public health. Despite low emissions, it bears high vulnerability. Renewables, green finance, and climate debt swaps are emerging as critical tools, but urgent, integrated policy action is needed to secure resilience and economic stability amid fiscal constraints....

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FY26 Economic Survey: Economy remains fragile despite recovery claims - Business Recorder

Pakistan's FY2025–26 economy shows resilience amid inflation spikes (6.2% avg) and Middle East conflict-driven oil price shocks. GDP grew 3.7%, driven by services (4.1%) and industrial recovery. Fiscal discipline, remittances, and forex reserves (USD21.3B) stabilized the balance of payments. Renewables and ICT growth are key policy focuses, while energy prices remain volatile....

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Pakistan’s IT exports: momentum without depth - BR Research - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s IT exports show growth amid macroeconomic strain, but remain fragile due to low-value, freelance-driven activity vulnerable to AI. Key challenges include weak talent employability, lack of domestic digital infrastructure, limited captive operations, and regulatory friction. Reforms are needed to shift from volume to quality, ensuring sustainable, high-value IT exports....

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KCCI demands reversal of failed policies

Pakistani business groups urge federal government to restore export-friendly tax regimes, reverse punitive measures, and revive RCET to boost competitiveness. They welcome PM Shehbaz Sharif’s recent commitments but stress urgent reforms to address circular debt, digital invoicing delays, and renewables policy gaps....

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Govt fuel levy drives cost-push inflation - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan’s inflation surged to double digits driven by erratic petroleum levy hikes, undermining monetary policy. SBP rate hikes failed to curb inflation, as cost-push fuel inflation resisted traditional transmission. Energy-linked categories dominated inflation, and asymmetric fuel pricing distorts policy effectiveness, highlighting a flawed fiscal-monetary coordination....

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Misc

AI’s negative environmental footprint could rival major nations by 2030, UN study warns

AI expansion by 2030 could consume 400m tonnes of CO_2, 9.3 trillion litres of water, and 14,500 km² of land — straining resources in Asia and Africa. UNU urges global governance, transparency, and sustainable AI development to mitigate disproportionate environmental burdens....

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UK-funded climate accelerator selects 11 Pakistani firms

Pakistan’s 2026 Climate Finance Accelerator cohort includes 11 businesses, backed by UK funding to scale low-carbon solutions. The programme has unlocked over $500M globally, with $40M allocated to Pakistan, supporting renewables, energy, transport, and circular economy initiatives to advance the nation’s climate transition....

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Senate exceeds austerity target by 500%

Pakistan’s Senate achieved Rs1.436bn in savings (15.9% of its 2025-26 budget) via austerity measures, suspending procurement, cutting travel, and halting vehicle purchases. Officials emphasize fiscal discipline, transparency, and public trust, positioning this as a sustained commitment to responsible governance and efficient resource use....

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Uneasy calm returns as Iran, Israel pull back from brink

Middle East tensions eased temporarily after Israel-Iran strikes paused, amid U.S. diplomatic intervention by Trump. U.S. maintains blockade of Iranian ships, EU imposes new sanctions. Iran vows to defend Strait of Hormuz, expands regional security belt. Renewed tensions in Gulf, with Houthi threats to Israeli-linked vessels. Renewed focus on energy chokepoints and regional instability....

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Budget likely to be presented on June 12: Parliamentary affairs minister

Pakistan's federal budget, delayed to June 12, faces scrutiny amid IMF conditions, provincial share revenue extraction, and regional energy volatility. The budget will be debated in Parliament before approval, as the government navigates fiscal consolidation and climate resilience funding amid global energy market pressures....

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LHC rules courts cannot act as regulators in economic policy matters

Lahore High Court rejects citizen petitions challenging power sector tariffs and capacity charges, affirming judicial restraint in economic policy. It upholds separation of powers, stating courts cannot review energy regulations or direct recovery of IPP payments — reinforcing legislative/executive authority over energy policymaking....

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How Agentic AI could transform the SME sector

Pakistan's SMEs, vital to its economy, face operational inefficiencies. Agentic AI offers transformative potential by democratizing enterprise-level intelligence, enabling autonomous workflows. However, unequal access risks deepening digital divides. Pakistan must adopt targeted public-private AI partnerships to empower SMEs, ensuring they compete globally through organizational agility—not just capital....

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Can Siri finally speak for Apple?

Apple unveiled a pragmatic AI strategy at WWDC, focusing on Siri enhancements and developer tools, partnering with Google's Gemini to accelerate capabilities without massive R&D spending. Despite delays and regional restrictions, financial resilience and privacy-first approach persist. Leadership transition looms as Apple seeks to balance AI innovation with user trust....

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K-P urged to prioritise industrialisation

Pakistan's Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa urges industrial focus in Budget 2026-27, citing energy, infrastructure, and finance constraints. Proposes an Industrial Development Fund to boost value-added manufacturing, counteracting raw material exports, and spur employment and revenue....

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LHC rejects challenge to power tariffs

Lahore High Court dismisses petition challenging power tariffs and capacity charges, affirming judicial restraint in energy policy. Court rules judiciary cannot review economic or regulatory decisions, reinforcing separation of powers and limiting public interest litigation in energy matters....

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$38b remittances dwarf exports

Pakistan's budget season is marked by corporate lobbying for subsidies, while overseas Pakistanis—sending $38B in remittances—quietly fuel the economy. Despite stagnant exports and outdated models, remittances and private sector innovation outperform state-led growth. The government must prioritize remittance recipients and modernization over corporate concessions....

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First deep conversion refinery planned in Hub

Pakistan's first deep conversion greenfield refinery in Hub, Balochistan, is advancing with government support, aiming to boost energy security, create 2,000 jobs, and catalyze petrochemicals. The project, backed by SPEC Refinery, seeks to reduce imports and attract investment, leveraging Pakistan's strategic location and growing domestic market....

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Energy crisis shows need to speed up transition: climate envoys - World - Business Recorder

Middle East conflict and global heatwaves intensify pressure for urgent clean energy transition. COP31, hosted by Turkey with Australian leadership, underscores fossil fuel dependency as a driver of inflation and instability. Key voices call for accelerated renewables, electrification, and reduced fossil fuel reliance amid escalating energy crises....

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Dar reviews auto policy for EV transition - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government, led by Deputy PM/FM Ishaq Dar, is accelerating EV adoption via a new Auto & Auto Parts Policy, aiming to boost manufacturing, jobs, exports, and climate goals. A stakeholder-led subcommittee will finalize the draft, signaling strong policy commitment to a sustainable, competitive automotive sector....

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Federal Budget now likely to be announced on 12th - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal government may delay its 2026–27 budget presentation to June 12 due to finalizing key allocations. Higher funds allocated to Balochistan, Sindh, and KP; Punjab gets least. K-IV Water Project and Sukkur-Hyderabad Motorway slated for launch. Coalition negotiations on PSDP concluded....

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Partly Facetious: The budget controversy - Opinion - Business Recorder

Government budget controversy centers on salary hikes for 7% of workforce, IMF approval, and frozen divisible pool. Development spending to be slashed despite budget rhetoric. Political maneuvering highlights coalition fragility and constitutional uncertainty. Renewables not mentioned....

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Plea challenging capacity payment mechanism for IPPs dismissed - Pakistan - Business Recorder

LHC dismisses IPPs' constitutional challenge on capacity payments, affirming judicial restraint and separation of powers. Courts cannot review energy policy or tariff structures; such matters remain with regulators and policymakers. The ruling reinforces constitutional boundaries, rejecting claims based on policy disagreement alone....

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Govt debt surges Rs1.4trn in April alone - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal government debt surged to Rs81.93 trillion in April 2026, driven by Rs882B in external borrowing and Rs523B in domestic debt. Fiscal pressures intensify as reliance on borrowing grows, with no significant renewables investment highlighted in this update....

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Pak-China friendship reaches new heights: Tarar - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan reaffirms its commitment to CPEC and deepening China ties, citing strengthened bilateral cooperation, shared vision, and people-to-people bonds. Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's visit to China injected new momentum, while the government highlights cultural, media, and economic collaboration as key pillars of their "iron brother" partnership....

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Can oil derail AI? - Opinion - Business Recorder

U.S.-Israel-Iran conflict disrupts oil flows via Strait of Hormuz, spurring inflation fears and forcing central banks to reconsider rate paths. This shocks financial markets, impacting AI valuations by elevating interest-rate risks—potentially reshaping tech investment assumptions beyond energy alone....

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Agri, industry & mining sectors: CPEC-2.0 to create new JVs: PCJCCI - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

CPEC-2.0 boosts Pakistan-China economic ties, with USD25.9B investment, 260K jobs, and 8GW power. Key projects accelerate infrastructure, trade via Gwadar, and hydrocarbon potential in Indus Delta. Renewables and energy security are highlighted amid strategic regional integration....

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Diesel engines for generators from US, Europe: New customs values set to check under-invoicing - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's DG Customs has introduced new valuation rules for imported diesel generator engines, aiming to curb under-invoicing. Based on market data and stakeholder input, customs values will be charged in USD per kVA/KG (whichever is higher), aligning with Section 25A of the Customs Act. This move strengthens import controls and revenue collection....

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Jam, SPEC Refinery discuss Hub greenfield project progress - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's first deep conversion greenfield refinery (USD 4.5B, Hub, Balochistan) aims to boost energy security, reduce imports, and spur petrochemicals. Government supports regulatory approvals; project promises 2,000 jobs and regional industrial growth. Public-private collaboration key to unlocking economic potential....

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Hormuz block sparks 'never seen before' disruption: Shell CEO - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Hormuz blockade disrupts global oil supplies, sparking price spikes and rationing in Asia. Shell's Q1 profits rise amid oil surges but gas production suffers. Qatar's LNG hub damaged by strikes; recovery expected by end of next Q1. War tensions persist, delaying energy rebalancing....

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'Govt is providing subsidy despite sharp rise in fuel prices' - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government is subsidizing fuel and supporting small farmers amid global fuel price hikes, cutting PSAP spending to prioritize relief. Senate achieved significant savings via austerity measures. The Economic Survey for FY2025-26 is set for release, amid global economic strain and Middle East conflict....

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4pc growth target set: Rs3.669trn uplift outlay approved by economic council - Business Recorder

Pakistan's NEC approved a Rs3.669 trillion 2026-27 budget, prioritizing infrastructure, energy, and SDGs, with Rs116B for energy. Renewables not detailed, but AI-driven project monitoring is introduced. GDP target set at 4%, fuel relief provided amid rising oil prices. IMF commitment reinforced; defense and social development key....

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Why Houthis threatening Red Sea shipping could mean more for the oil market this time - World - DAWN.COM

Houthis threaten to ban Israeli-linked ships in Red Sea, escalating regional tensions. Iran's Hormuz closure disrupted Gulf exports; Saudi Arabia diverted 70% of crude to Yanbu. Houthis, aligned with Iran ideologically but not militarily, seek to pressure Israel/US, risking global energy flows. Renewables remain unaffected, but geopolitical risks heighten energy market volatility....

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Pak-Iran border trade halt to trigger LPG shortages - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's Gabd-Rimdan border closure has disrupted LPG imports, causing shortages and soaring prices. Customs delays and security issues at other borders strain energy supply. Exports of perishables and energy goods are at risk, with officials urging urgent government intervention to restore trade and prevent nationwide energy and food crises....

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BUDGET 2026-27: Budget timing in doubt after NEC meeting put off again - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Federal-provincial fiscal tensions escalate as Islamabad seeks Rs1T+ for strategic needs, sparking protests from provinces like KP, fearing deficits. Political deadlock, constitutional concerns, and IMF surplus commitments complicate consensus. KP urges urgent talks with Imran Khan, highlighting gas shortages, delayed infrastructure, and unequal resource distribution. Budget delays loom as technical and political hurdles persist....

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BUDGET 2026-27: Budget timing in doubt after NEC meeting put off again - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Federal-provincial fiscal tensions escalate as Islamabad seeks Rs1T+ for strategic needs, sparking protests over NFC share freezes. KP warns of deficit risks, calling for Imran Khan's intervention. Energy projects like Swat dam and Peshawar bus terminal stall due to bureaucratic delays. Renewables and gas production remain underutilized despite provincial output....

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World's first wind-powered underwater datacentre starts operating in China

China deploys the world's first wind-powered underwater datacentre off Shanghai, reducing energy use by 20% and freshwater demand. Backed by government investment and AI strategy, this marks rapid commercialization of marine renewables. While promising, ecological impacts require monitoring....

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Federal Budget 2026-27 likely to be presented on June 12, says minister

Pakistan's federal budget for FY2026-27 is delayed to June 12 amid coalition negotiations, with focus on fiscal consolidation, IMF coordination, and public welfare. Development spending exceeds Rs1.1 trillion. Renewables not highlighted; tax reforms and macroeconomic stability central to revised framework....

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